

Former Waste Disposal Sites

Soft spots, sinkholes

May indicate decomposing waste below the surface

Mounds or expanding soil

Evidence of gas build-up

Discolored soil, stunted vegetation

Can be evidence of toxic chemicals in the soil



Health hazards

Landfill gases contain carbon dioxide, methane, volatile organic compounds (VOCs), hazardous air pollutants, and “odorous” compounds that can adversely affect public health and the environment.



Use of “capped” landfills

A landfill is capped when it's ... well, full. Capping involves covering it with soil, then planting grass for aesthetics. Any natural gases caused by waste decomposition are expelled through ventilation pipes. Test wells are installed and monitored for groundwater contamination. Sometimes, old landfills are turned into a park or golf course! Fore!